

treatment. In case of families where younger children had included their elderly parents in family floater insurance cover can worry less as the scope of their insurance cover on treatment for themselves will be less impacted with this new policy dedicatedly available to their parents.

On the flip side, this cover may not be useful for all, as the empaneled hospitals may not be the ones where certain long-term patients may find their doctors to continue treatment. Likewise, the kind of facilities that one can opt for under this policy, such as private rooms, is yet to be finalised. The increasing load on hospitals is another aspect that one will need to wait and watch, because bringing diagnostics and testing under the insurance cover could lead to long queues that could delay treatments.

TRACK DEPOSIT INSURANCE CLAIMS

It can be frustrating to be a customer of a failed bank, especially if you are waiting for claims on deposits of up to Rs 5 lakh as part of the deposit insurance. The Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC), a subsidiary of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) which administers such claims, has recently launched Daava Soochak, an online claim status tracker to help depositors track the status of their claims.

You can now visit www.dicgc.org.in and locate the tracker displayed prominently on the homepage. Then select the bank from the dropdown list and key in your mobile number to know the status of your claim. The services now cover banks under All-Inclusive Directions (AID) from April 1, 2024 onwards. The deposit insurance scheme is mandatory for banks, which also have to bear the insurance premiums. Currently, 97.8 per cent of deposit accounts in India are fully protected under this scheme.

According to the DICGC Act, 1967 (amended in 2021), depositors are entitled to receive their claims within 90 days in case of failure of the bank. Prior to this amendment, depositors could gain access to the insurance cover only if their banks went into liquidation. They had to wait endlessly for the RBI to decide if the bank needed to go for liquidation or not. In 2023-24, the DICGC settled claims amounting to Rs 1,432 crore for liquidated banks and those under AID, while recovering Rs 900.7 crore, mostly from liquidated and transferee banks.

UPI-BASED CASH DEPOSITS AT BANKS

Customers of some banks can now make cash deposits into ATMs using any UPI app enabled by an Interoperable Cash Deposit (ICD) functionality. This facility simplifies the cash deposit process by eliminating the use of physical debit cards. While initially available at select ATMs of banks like Axis Bank and Union Bank of India, more banks are expected to adopt this service in the near future.

EARLIER, DEPOSITORS IN FAILED BANKS COULD GAIN ACCESS TO THE INSURANCE COVER ONLY IF THE BANK WENT INTO LIQUIDATION

The process isn't simple yet because you need to identify an ATM which is equipped with advanced cash recycler machines that support UPI-ICD. There is currently a limit of Rs 50,000 per transaction to make such a deposit. Once you open the UPI app, you can scan the QR code on the ATM scheme to get started and insert the cash into the ATM deposit slot. After this step, you will receive a confirmation for the deposit. You can also transfer funds to anyone using the UPI app after you have deposited the money into your account. ■

–Narayan Krishnamurthy